to greet him. Among them was Hamida.

'Who is this?'[31] asked Humayun, and was informed that she was the daughter of Mir Baba Dost, then employed as Hindal's teacher of religion. Hamida's young brother, Muazzam, was part of the gathering too; turning to him, Humayun remarked, 'This boy will be one of my kinsmen . . .'
– and then, of Hamida, 'She, too, is related to me.'

Possibly, he meant they were all related through the venerable Shaikh Ahmad of Jam: Humayun's own mother, Maham Begum, was also a descendant of his. As a pickup line, the remark was more smug than charming, and impressed neither Hamida nor Hindal. Some days later, when Humayun came to Dildar Begum and pressed the point more forcefully – 'Mir Baba Dost is related to us. It is fitting that you should give me his daughter in marriage' – Hindal exploded. According to Jouher, who was present at the spot, if not at the scene, 'the Prince Hindal was very angry with his brother, and said, "I thought you came here to do me honour, not to look out for a young bride: if you commit this [ridiculous] action, I will leave you."'

Gulbadan, too, writes that Hindal kept 'making objections' to the match, arguing that he 'looked upon this girl as a sister and child of my own' and that Humayun couldn't afford to marry. Gulbadan adds that Hamida 'was often in [Hindal's] residence', thus allowing for the speculation that Hindal's interest in her was more romantic than protective. He was certainly closer to her in age: Hamida was fourteen, Hindal twenty-two, and Humayun a relatively ancient thirty-three.

Whatever the reason for his objections, Hindal was adamant and Humayun furious. He stormed out of Dildar's tent, and, according to Jouher, 'went on board a boat'. The frazzled begum took a stern line with both men. With Hindal, writes Jouher, she was 'very angry', telling him off for speaking rudely to his elder brother 'whom you ought to consider as the representative of your late father'. To Humayun, she wrote a calming but firm letter, comforting him with news that Hamida's own mother had shown interest in the match, but also expressing her own astonishment 'that you should go away in anger over a few words'.[32] The brothers duly chastened, Dildar went to Humayun, brought him off his boat and out of his sulk, and arranged a conciliatory party.